

POLICY, POVERTY AND POLITICS. HOW PUBLIC HEALTH, INEQUALITY AND POLITICAL LEADERSHIP INTERACT IN THE COVID PANDEMIC

IAS COVID-19 CONFERENCE: PREVENTION

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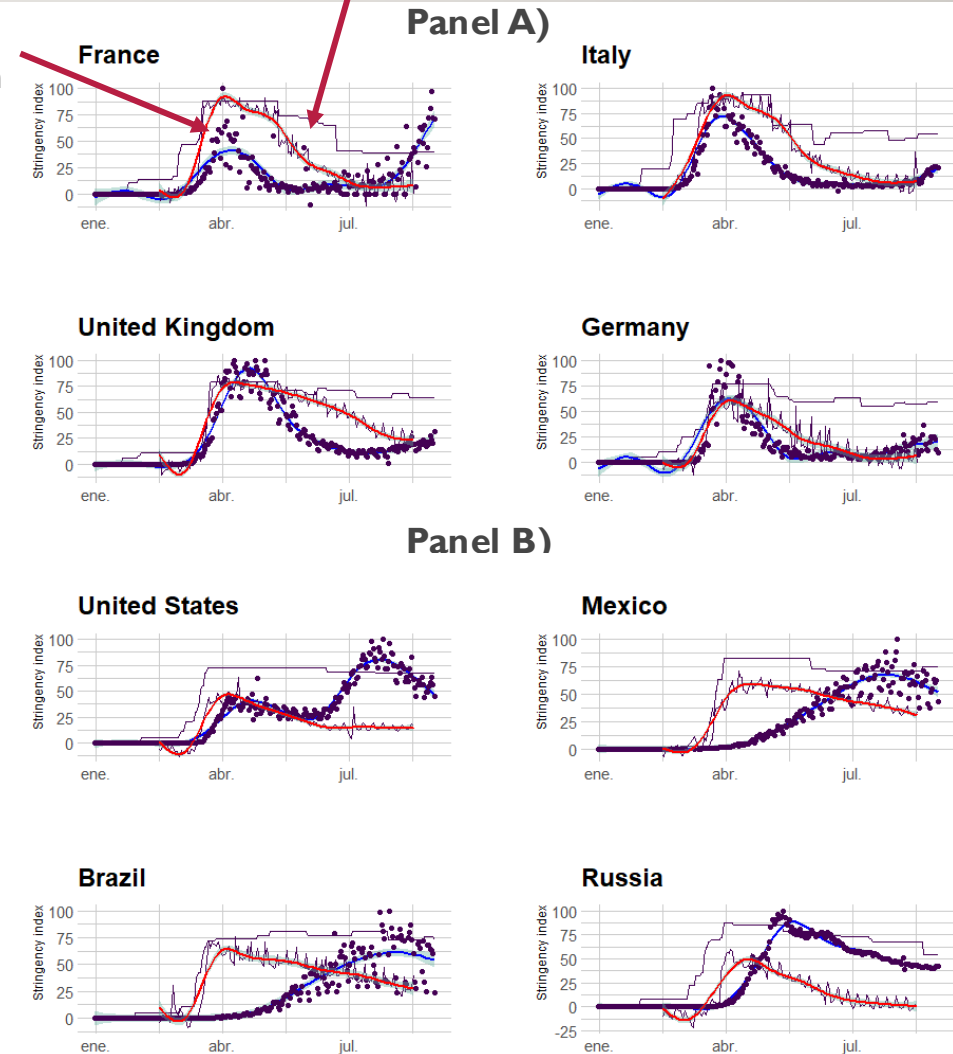
BACKGROUND

NPI AND COMPLIANCE

- NPIs include a variety of measures - social distancing, school closures, workplace closures, travel restrictions, border closures, and large-scale lockdowns of populations
- The effectiveness of the NPIs depends on public compliance with them. The extent to which the NPIs implemented resulted in population mobility reductions also differed.

Mobility reduction

Stringency of the government response



BEYOND THE GOVERNMENT RESPONSE

Important to understand the factors that may affect the ability and willingness of populations around the world to comply with NPIs

Two important determinants: Ability and willingness

(Ability) Inequity conditions make more vulnerable population

- Informal work
- Insecure income
- Access to social protection systems

(Willingness) Political leadership

- simplifying the pandemic by downplaying its impacts or touting easy solutions or treatments
- Delivered a weaker response to COVID-19 than non-populist

OBJECTIVE

- The objective of this work is to assess the effect of the policy response to the COVID-19 crisis on the epidemic (daily cases), accounting for economic inequality and political leadership, as determinants of compliance.

METHODS

METHODS: DATA

- *The Oxford COVID-19 Government Response Tracker (OxCGRT)*
 - Real time collected data by the University of Oxford
 - Available information about 17 indicators of government responses to mitigate COVID-19
 - Measures on: Movement restrictions, containment and economic Support
 - An overall index of response between 0 y 100 – level of stringency of government to cope the pandemic
- Mobility data– Google “Community Mobility Reports”.
 - To evaluate changes in response to policies or restriction measures
 - Patterns of movement over time by geography, in different categories of places such as shops, recreational places, pharmacies, parks, transport stations, workplaces and residences.
- Inequality and GDP – World bank
- Populism data– Global Party Survey.
 - Project that uses an expert survey to address question such as How do political parties in countries around the globe differ

METHODS: ANALYSIS STRATEGY

- We use a panel model with random effects to identify the effect of policy response on the number of daily cases
 - Lagged dependent variable – 14 days between stringency and new cases
 - Observation starts with 300 cases reported
 - 107 countries with an average 140 days of follow up
- We take advantage a three sources of variation in the Government response
 - Time
 - Stringency
 - Compliance (mobility reduction)

$$Y_{p,t} = \beta_0 + \sum_{h=1}^h \beta_h X_p + \beta_3 GINI_p + \beta_3 Populism_p + \sum_{i=1}^i \beta_i Response_{p,t} + \sum_{j=1}^j \beta_j Mobility_{p,t} + \sum_{k=1}^k \beta_k Response * Mobility_{p,t}$$

RESULTS

RESULTS. PANEL DATA ANALYSIS.

Ability

Willingness

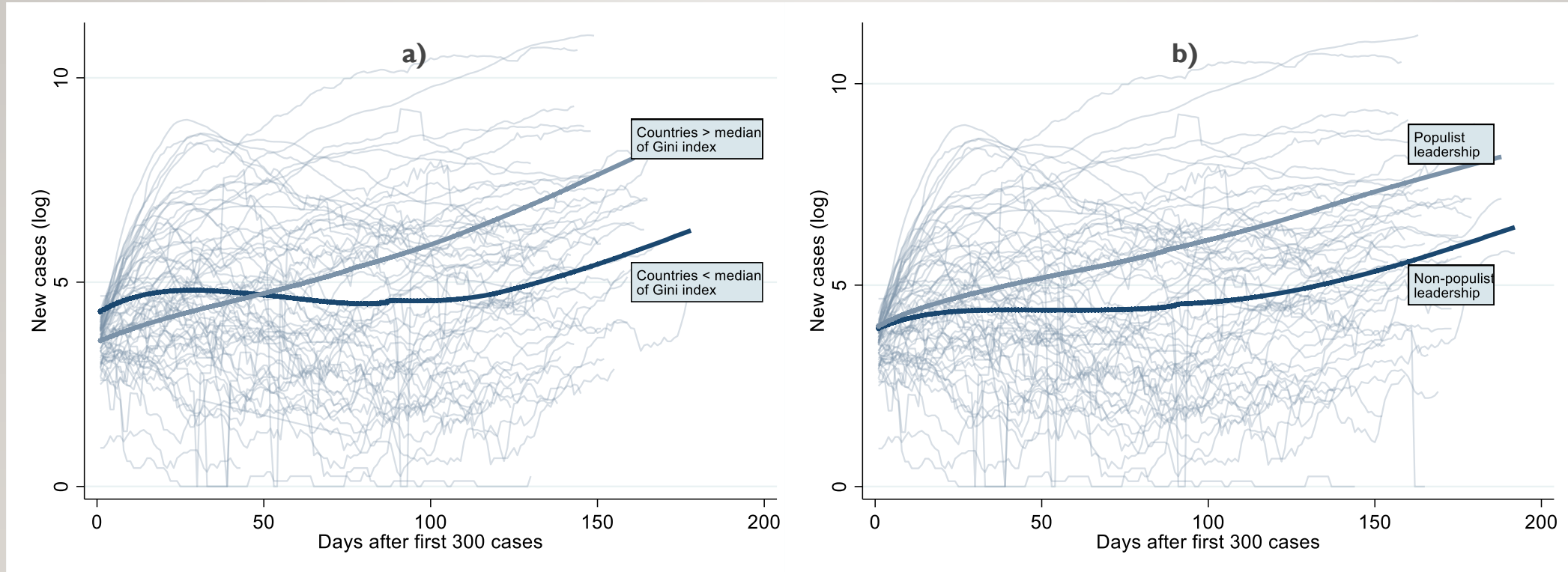


TABLE 4. PANEL DATA ANALYSIS.

	New cases			
	I	II	III	IV
Government response	-7	41**	41**	41**
Mobility		70.9**	70.8**	70.8**
Government response & mobility		-140**	-140**	-140**
GINI			154**	161*
Populist leadership				2,019*
Observations	12,182	12,182	12,182	12,182
Number of Countries	93	93	93	93

All models controlled by GDP, Population size, Days since first case,

** == $p < 0.01$

* == $p < 0.05$

CONCLUSIONS

- **We find variation in both the response and population compliance, consequently different outcomes in the epidemic**
- **As in other studies, we find that NPI had a positive effect on containing the epidemic**
- **Compliance helps explain the impact of the policy response**
- **Compliance is key – by ability and willingness**

THANK YOU!

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